Citi Research



16 October 2026

PULSE Monitor

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ee Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

Market Outlook

	Positive	Neutral	Negative
Price			✓
Unanticipated			✓
Liquidity			✓
_entiment			✓
_arnings	✓		

urce: Citi Research

Key Takeaways

P: "Price" holds at negative as cross asset valuations sit in the top decile, yet forward multiples are now below 10yr averages.

U: "Unanticipated" stays negative as equity implied vol begins to work higher from relatively benign levels.

L: "Liquidity" holds at negative as sizable Domestic Equity fund outflows continue.

S: "Sentiment" stays negative. Multiples sit marginally above the top end of the FV range and Levkovich Index firmly in euphoric territory.

E: "Earnings" are a positive, revisions trends are robust yet positive surprises have been muted thus far in the 3Q reporting period (Fins).

Weekly Highlights

If one word describes our US Equity commentary this week it is "cracks". The Q3 earnings season is still too early to judge. We continue expecting a normal positive surprise, yet Financials' earnings have led to minimal positive revisions relative to prior quarters. This week's CPI print has caused consternation as probability of another Fed rate hike this year seems increasingly likely. Treasury yields have whipped around quite notably. Implied volatility measures have worked mostly higher in response. As for the AI trade, the focus on capex financing has moved even more front and center as yields on one notable issuer debt has triggered incremental concern as to the supply vs demand circumstance going forward. We do not take this lightly as the response in semi and other component suppliers this week reminds how sensitive the market is to persistence of the AI infrastructure buildout. To top off, Equity flows were negative while Levkovich Index remains in euphoria. Expect macro and micro to face off as the earnings season unfolds.

Our Stance on US Equities

We lift our base case year-end 2026 target for the S&P 500 to 8100. This is predicated on a big step up in earnings expectations where we now project $365 and $400 for 2026/2027 index level earnings. We allow for some multiple compression relative to our prior forecasts as the AI-triggered growth phase is clearly well underway. Our bull/bear cases imply increasing downside skew risk as the index works higher (US Equity Strategy - Earnings Strength Drives Target Revision), US Equity Strategy - Mid-Quarter Update: 8100 Remains in Line of Sight

Our Q4 sector recommendations can be best described as eclectic. AI tailwinds should persist for now while the macro set up allows for a combination of rate sensitive defensive and contrarian exposures. Info Tech remains a market weight but we lift Semis back to OW offset by a Hardware UW. Consumer Discretionary remains a contrarian OW, while we cushion for a Dem sweep midterm contingency with an UW Fins OW HC pair. Utes and Telecom OW provide leverage to a less aggressive Fed tightening path than priced. (US Equity Strategy - SIGN (Sector & Industry Group Navigator): Navigating Uncertainty).

have been emphasizing our ongoing view that AI is influencing over % of the S&P 500 capitalization. A Growth/Cyclicals/Defensives ster approach provides a good framework for assessing the index portunity at this point. US Equity Strategy - Framing the Growth rrative

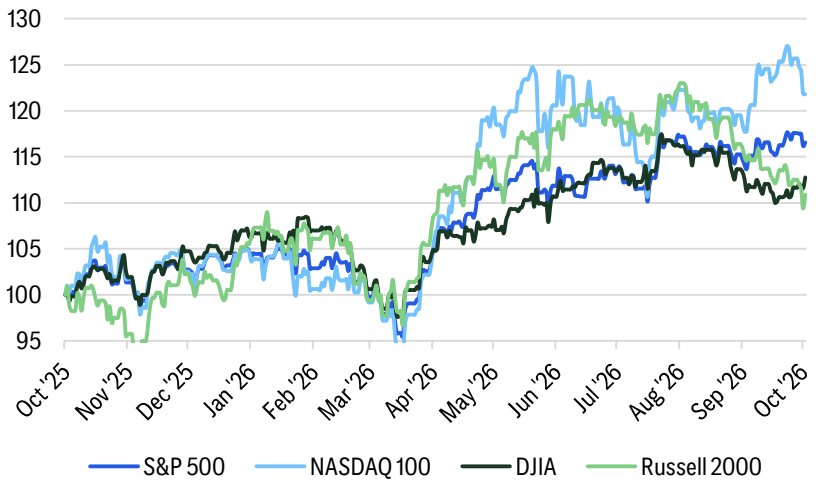
ere are some subtle influences at work inside the S&P 500 index the Growth cluster has expanded. An increasing percentage of h beta stocks influences realized volatility and is reflected in ighted index beta to equal weight. In turn the betas for Cyclicals d Defensives are moving lower as is average stock beta. Economic nsitivity is lesser. Further, historic valuation comparisons need ntext. US Equity Strategy - AI's Subtle S&P 500 Impacts

Citi Estimates vs. Consensus/Market Pricing

S&P 500 Price Target	Citi	Market Pricing *
Dec 2024	5882	
Dec 2025	6846	
Dec 2026 E	8100	7804

S&P 500 EPS (TTM)	Citi	Consensus **
Dec 2024	246	
Dec 2025	276	
Dec 2026 E	365	366
Dec 2027 E	400	424

Major US Index Performance, 1 Year (Rebased to 100)

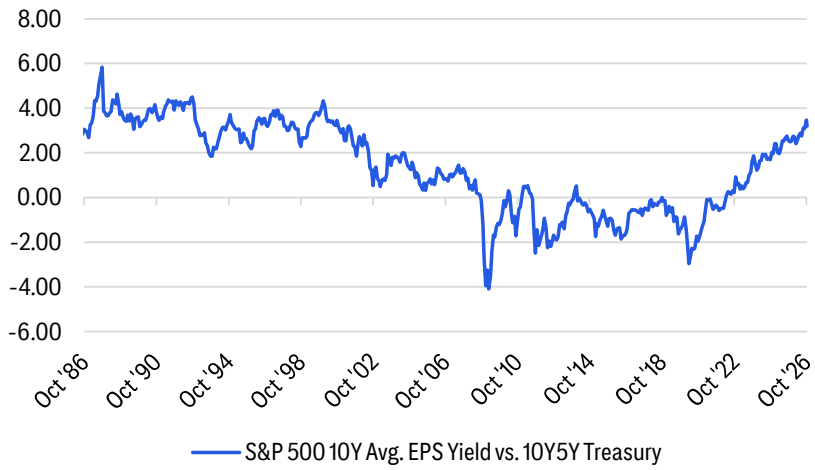


Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Citi Research. * based on S&P 500 Index and SPDR S&P 500 options pricing. ** bottom-up consensus estimates.

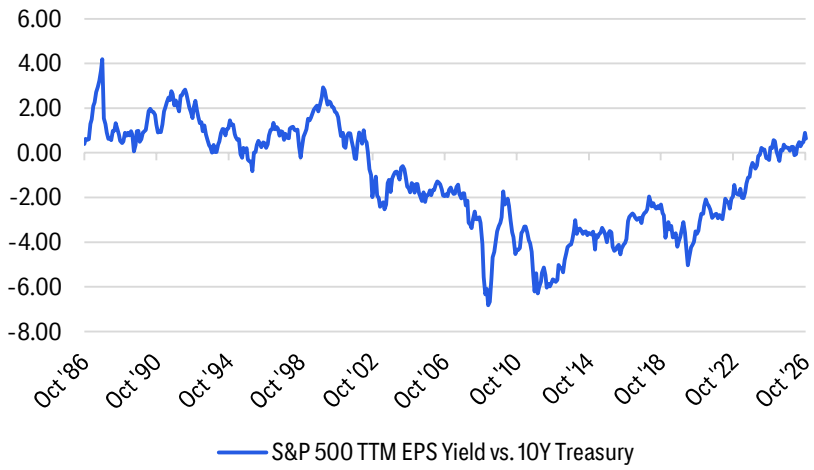
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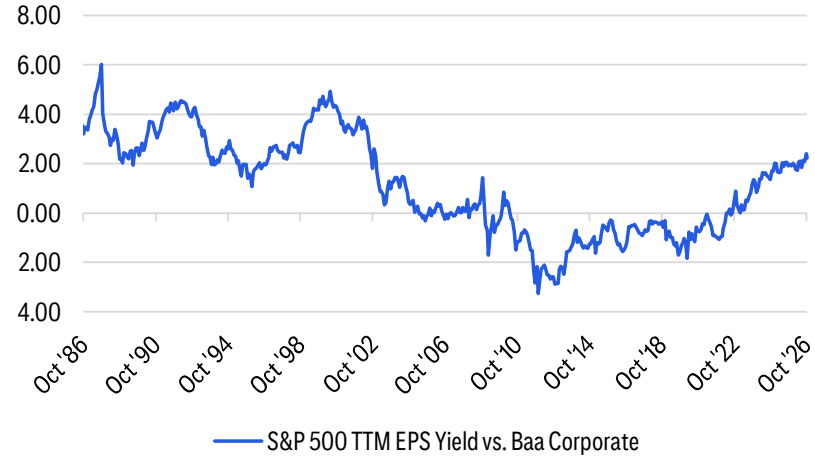
S&P 500 Normalized Yield Gap



S&P 500 Trailing 10-Year Yield Gap



S&P 500 Trailing Baa Yield Gap



S&P 500 Yield Gap Statistics

	Normalized Yield Gap		Trailing 10Y Yield Gap		Trailing Baa Yield Gap		S&P 500
Last Close	3.18%		0.64%		2.23%		
Timeframe	40Y	5Y	40Y	5Y	40Y	5Y	40Y
Percentile	75%	98%	72%	98%	66%	98%	
Decile	8	10	8	10	7	10	
Forward 1-Year Returns (Based on Decile)							
Median	17.7%	14.5%	12.7%	12.0%	17.6%	12.8%	11.9%
90th Percentile	31.3%	25.9%	30.0%	22.7%	31.1%	24.2%	28.5%
10th Percentile	-15.3%	-0.5%	-15.0%	-1.9%	0.9%	-3.8%	-11.0%
Up Probability	68%	88%	71%	87%	92%	86%	79%

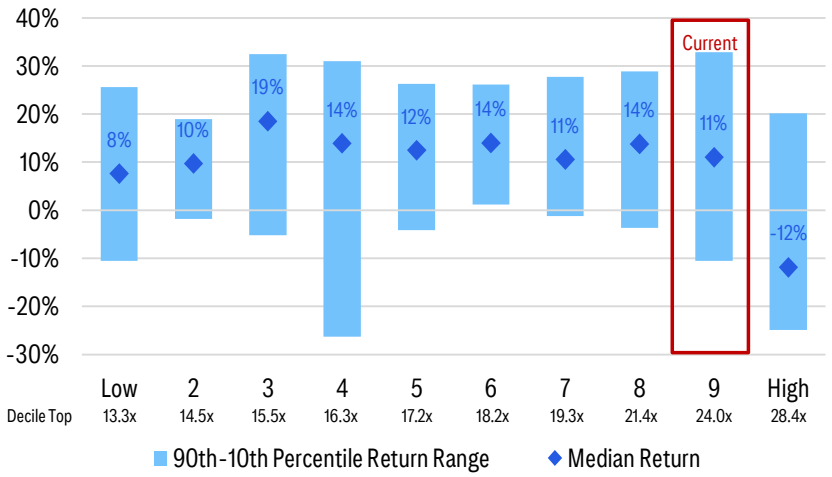
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Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Citi Research.

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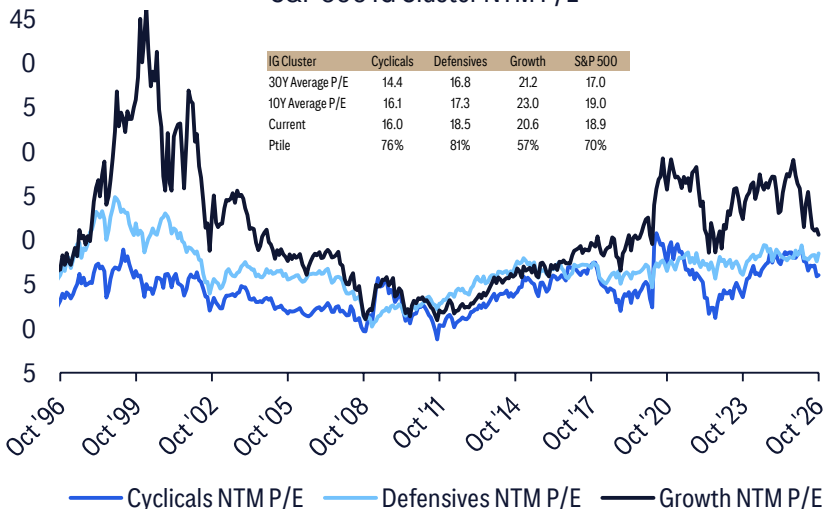
S&P 500 1Y Forward Returns by P/E TTM Decile*



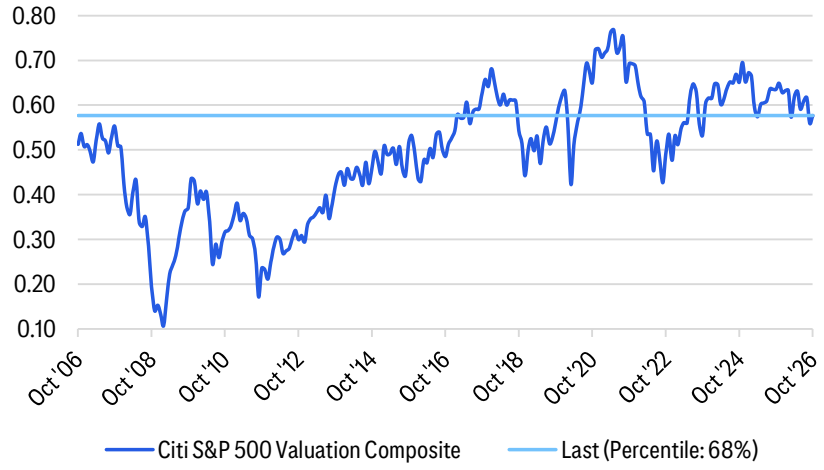
S&P 500 Valuation Statistics

	P/E TTM	P/E NTM	P/B	P/S	EV/ EBITDA	Div Yield	S&P 500
Index Valuation Data							
Last Close	22.5	18.9	5.3	3.5	16.0	1.31%	
Percentile*	85%	77%	99%	100%	93%	1%	
Decile*	9	8	10	10	10	1	
Forward 1-Year Returns (Based on Decile)							
Median	11.3%	7.4%	-10.7%	19.0%	19.0%	-10.7%	11.9%
90th Percentile	32.7%	21.1%	22.6%	28.8%	28.8%	32.1%	27.9%
10th Percentile	-10.0%	-10.2%	-24.5%	4.4%	9.5%	-24.5%	-11.7%
Up Probability	69%	69%	31%	67%	76%	31%	79%

S&P 500 IG Cluster NTM P/E



S&P 500 Valuation Composite



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Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Citi Research. * Based on 40 years of monthly data.

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Negative Market Impact

- Absorption of New Issuance (IPOs & Secondaries)
- Iran and Oil back in the spotlight
- Prolonged Unwind of Concentrated Positioning
- Nonlinear Return to Target Inflation, Fed Hawkishness
- Margin Pressure from Input Cost Pressure (ex. Tariffs)
- Lack of Upside to 2026 Guidance
- Tariff Uncertainty Leading to Negative Company Commentary
- Above Expected Corporate Defaults, Credit Weakness

Positive Market Impact

- Corporate Preparedness for Economic Slowdown
- Broad Productivity Gains

Solid Quality, Profitability Metrics

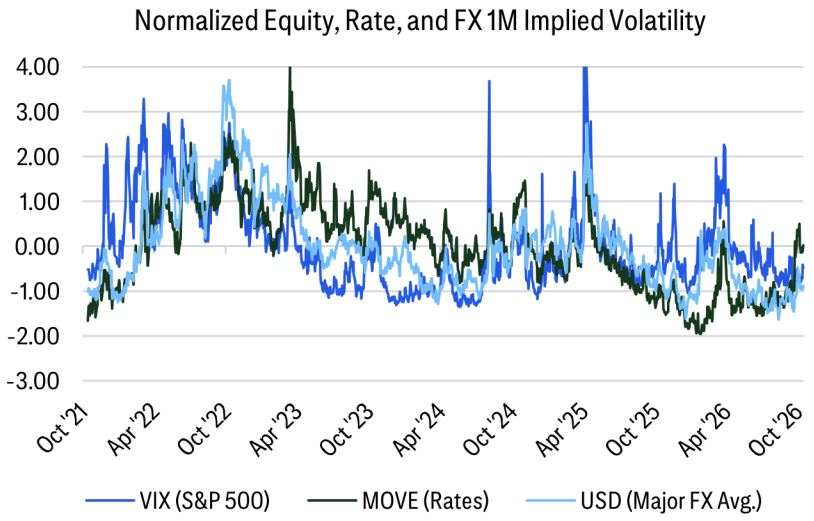
Abrupt Loosening of Monetary Policy

Near-Term EPS Impacts of Structural Themes (ex. AI)

Real Money Under Positioning in Risk Assets

Upside Hard and Soft Economic Data Surprises

Stimulative Fiscal Policy Driving Increased Investment



Implied Volatility Data

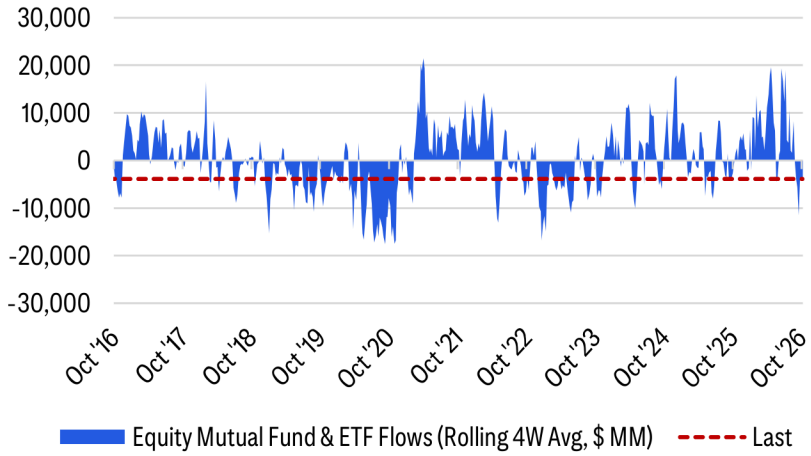
	Last Close			Week Ago
	Value	Z-Score (5Y)	Percentile (5Y)	Value
VIX (S&P 500)	16.46	-0.49	38%	15.41
VXN (NASDAQ)	22.89	-0.15	54%	21.98
RVX (Russell 2000)	20.56	-0.86	16%	21.02
MOVE (Rates)	102.49	0.03	51%	100.70
USD (Major FX Avg.)	6.97	-0.88	20%	7.01

Source: Bloomberg, Citi Research.

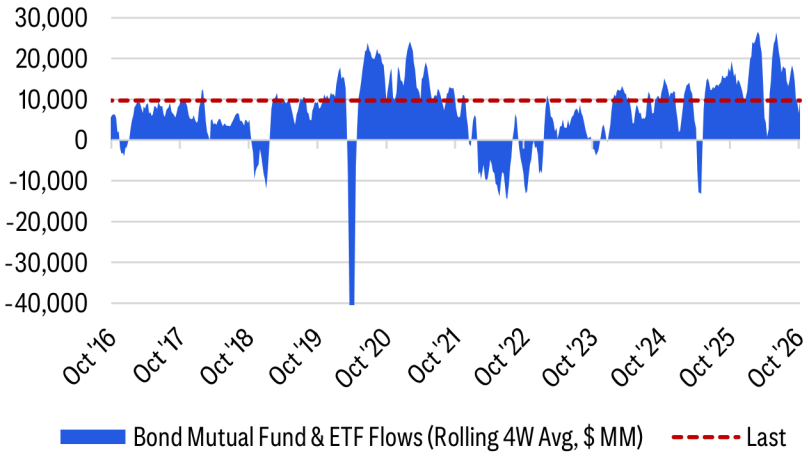
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Equity Fund Flows, Rolling 4-Week Average



Bond Fund Flows, Rolling 4-Week Average



Equity Mutual Fund & ETF Flows ($, MM)

	Last Week Ended 7 Oct		10Y Avg		Weekly
	Weekly Flow	Rolling 4-Week Avg	Weekly Flow	Rolling 4-Week Avg	Flow (In+, Out-) Streak
tal	-11,405	-3,943	204	204	-2
omestic	-18,354	-7,858	-734	-710	-2
orld	6,949	3,915	935	911	+3

Bond Mutual Fund & ETF Flows ($, MM)

	Last Week Ended 7 Oct		10Y Avg		Weekly
	Weekly Flow	Rolling 4-Week Avg	Weekly Flow	Rolling 4-Week Avg	Flow (In+, Out-) Streak
Total	24,527	9,727	6,850	6,832	+27
Taxable	25,434	10,056	6,193	6,170	+27
Municipal	-907	-330	657	662	-2

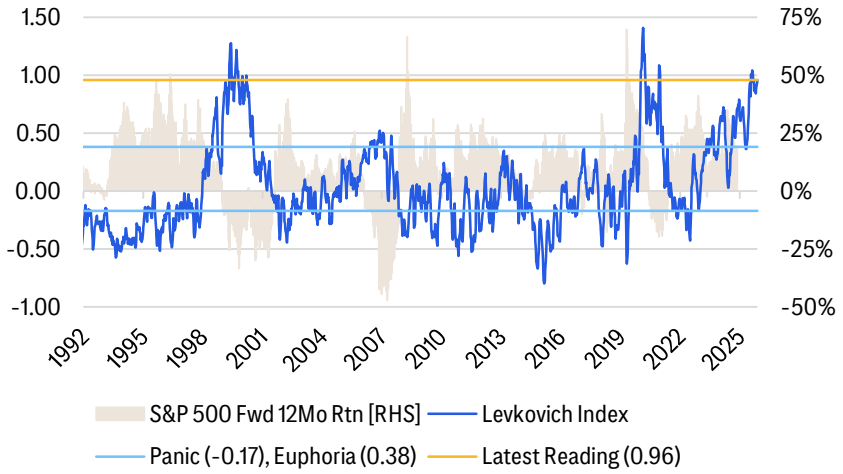
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Source: Bloomberg, Haver Analytics, ICI, Citi Research

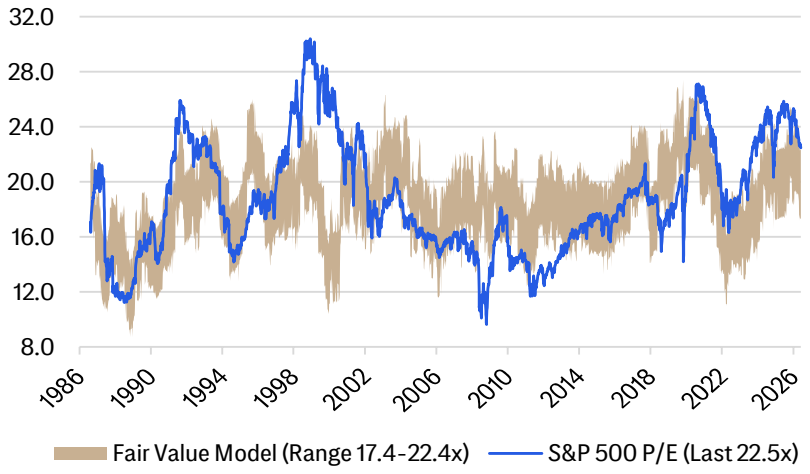
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Levkovich Index (Formerly Panic/Euphoria)



Citi S&P 500 Fair Value Model vs. Trailing P/E



Levkovich Index Statistics

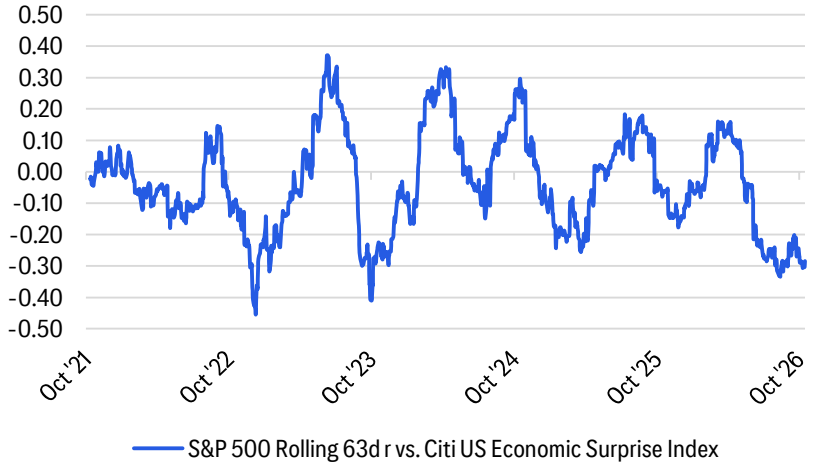
	Last (±0.10)	Panic	Neutral	Euphoria	S&P 500
vel	0.96	<= -0.17	-0.17 to 0.38	>= 0.38	
rward 1-Year Returns (Based on Level Ranges) *					
edian	-14.3%	17.7%	10.7%	-7.9%	11.7%
th Percentile	1.2%	32.6%	25.5%	17.1%	27.5%
th Percentile	-23.8%	2.9%	-9.7%	-21.4%	-12.3%
Probability	11%	96%	81%	38%	79%

kovich Index: NYSE short interest % of float, margin debt, TRF volume % of total, Market Vane and AAII llishness, NCF Nonfinancial Leverage, put/call ratio, CRB futures, gasoline prices, and 25 delta put/call skew.

r Value Model: 10Y yield, 10Y real GDP trend, EPS growth expectations, CPI%, changes in CPI%, Baa spreads, llar Index changes, 2Y yield changes, 2s10s Treasury slope, and NY Fed Recession Probability Index.

ongest signals come when market appears undervalued/overvalued on the Fair Value Model and the Levkovich Index is in panic/euphoria.

S&P 500 Correlation to Economic Data Surprises



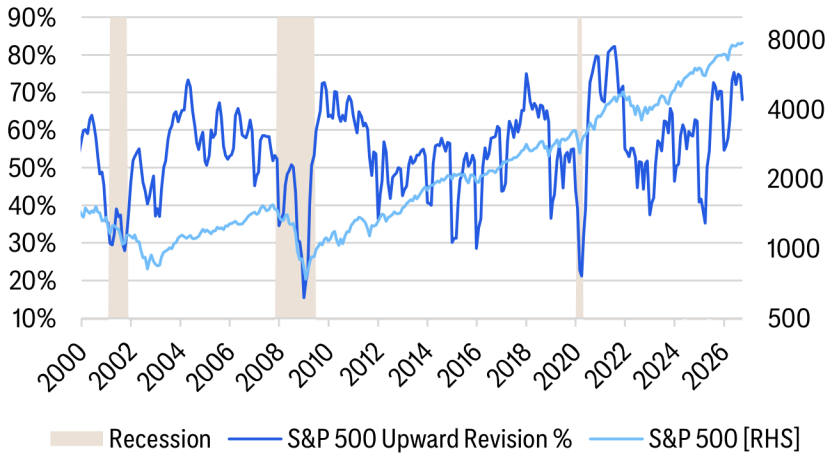
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Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Haver Analytics, Citi Research. * Based on weekly data since 1987.

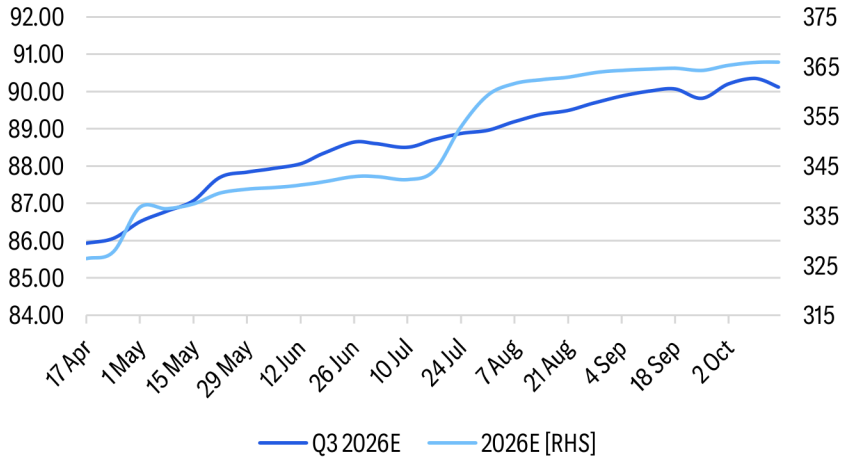
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S&P 500 Upward Revision %



S&P 500 Bottom-Up EPS Estimates, 6 Months



S&P 500 Monthly Upward Revisions as a % of Total Revisions

	Oct '26	Mth. Avg.	Sep '26	Jun '26	Mar '26	Dec '25
&P 500	68.1%	55.9%	74.3%	75.3%	57.7%	70.3%
ons. Disc.	57.7%	52.0%	62.4%	59.2%	41.6%	56.7%
ons. Stpl.	69.7%	54.1%	76.3%	73.1%	54.1%	56.3%
nergy	72.5%	50.8%	71.6%	67.7%	63.8%	69.4%
nancials	57.7%	56.2%	69.1%	72.4%	58.1%	75.8%
ealth Care	66.0%	63.1%	76.6%	71.3%	64.9%	81.7%
dustrials	64.6%	55.8%	79.0%	81.0%	51.6%	67.3%
fo. Tech.	93.8%	65.9%	90.5%	92.3%	73.6%	91.4%
aterials	36.1%	43.2%	47.2%	59.4%	39.2%	45.0%
eal Estate	61.2%	50.5%	65.2%	74.3%	45.2%	64.1%
omm. Serv.	56.2%	50.1%	66.1%	70.9%	59.2%	52.6%
tilities	61.3%	57.7%	52.6%	64.2%	57.0%	67.9%

S&P 500 Annual Earnings Progression

	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E
S&P 500 EPS							
Actual	122	211	220	222	246	276	
Consensus							366
Citi							365
S&P 500 EPS Growth							
Actual	-22.1%	72.5%	4.2%	1.1%	10.4%	12.4%	
Consensus							32.6%
Citi							32.2%

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Source: FactSet, Citi Research.

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S&P 500 Earnings Scorecard, Calendar Q3 2026

EPS in S&P 500 Index $ Per Share Terms	Q3 2026					CY 2026				
	12/31/2025	9/30/2026	10/15/2026	Chg QTD	% Chg QTD	12/31/2025	9/30/2026	10/15/2026	Chg QTD	% Chg QTD
Communication Services	$8.29	$8.27	$8.37	$0.10	1.2%	$32.54	$44.51	$44.74	$0.23	0.5%
Consumer Discretionary	$6.80	$6.50	$6.51	$0.01	0.1%	$24.27	$29.93	$29.90	-$0.03	-0.1%
Consumer Staples	$4.21	$3.98	$3.88	-$0.09	-2.3%	$15.69	$15.65	$15.44	-$0.20	-1.3%
Energy	$3.13	$6.48	$6.95	$0.47	7.2%	$12.07	$21.69	$22.84	$1.15	5.3%
Financials	$13.88	$13.99	$14.07	$0.08	0.6%	$54.68	$58.27	$58.50	$0.23	0.4%
Health Care	$9.13	$8.84	$8.19	-$0.65	-7.4%	$35.76	$33.36	$32.72	-$0.65	-1.9%
Industrials	$6.31	$6.17	$6.17	$0.00	0.0%	$23.92	$24.71	$24.59	-$0.12	-0.5%
Information Technology	$23.33	$29.43	$29.71	$0.28	0.9%	$90.70	$113.22	$113.81	$0.60	0.5%
Materials	$1.59	$1.70	$1.82	$0.12	7.2%	$6.03	$6.84	$7.06	$0.21	3.1%
Real Estate	$1.85	$1.83	$1.82	-$0.01	-0.3%	$7.36	$7.35	$7.34	-$0.01	-0.1%
Utilities	$2.63	$2.62	$2.63	$0.02	0.6%	$8.72	$8.69	$8.69	$0.00	0.1%
S&P 500	$81.35	$89.82	$90.11	$0.29	0.3%	$312.51	$364.55	$365.92	$1.37	0.4%

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Source: FactSet, Citi Research.

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Performance Table

US Equity Market and Key Macro Weekly Performance Table

	Close as of 14 Oct 2026	Last Close	1W % Chg	1M % Chg	3M % Chg	6M % Chg	1Y % Chg	YTD % Chg
Size & Style	S&P 500	7,719	-1.06	1.30	2.32	10.79	16.17	12.76
	Russell 2000	2,730	-2.28	-5.63	-7.93	0.88	9.38	9.98
	Russell 1000 Growth	5,002	-3.57	2.53	0.81	7.88	6.88	4.99
	Russell 1000 Value	2,499	1.30	-0.25	3.19	13.02	25.00	20.61
Factor	iShares MSCI USA Min Vol Factor ETF	100.63	1.15	0.43	3.87	7.43	6.26	6.87
	iShares MSCI USA Momentum Factor ETF	304.88	-5.44	1.73	-4.66	12.78	19.97	21.80
	iShares MSCI USA Quality Factor ETF	225.93	0.01	2.63	3.05	11.15	17.04	13.75
	iShares MSCI USA Value Factor ETF	193.46	-3.80	-3.58	-0.94	24.80	54.69	41.49
Sector	S&P 500 Communication Services	473	-0.22	-0.14	-0.06	0.86	13.62	4.65
	S&P 500 Consumer Discretionary	1,850	-0.72	-0.59	-2.63	-2.70	-1.38	-4.04
	S&P 500 Consumer Staples	966	5.60	3.41	4.68	5.12	9.65	11.69
	S&P 500 Energy	1,040	6.92	5.69	19.69	21.31	57.20	51.37
	S&P 500 Financials	906	1.37	-4.25	-2.99	5.26	2.33	-0.57
	S&P 500 Health Care	2,028	2.95	3.93	9.88	16.87	22.16	12.29
	S&P 500 Industrials	1,414	-0.52	-1.48	-7.39	-3.68	9.00	7.67
	S&P 500 Information Technology	7,129	-4.79	3.56	5.88	25.17	28.13	25.42
	S&P 500 Materials	630	1.16	-0.64	-0.83	-4.01	11.13	9.73
	S&P 500 Real Estate	269	2.21	-3.02	-6.49	-3.39	5.11	6.90
	S&P 500 Utilities	424	1.35	0.39	-8.65	-10.25	-8.96	-2.29
Citi RSCH	Citi US Large Cap Recommended List	201	-1.61	-1.75	-6.64	5.34	28.55	14.66
	Citi "Value Creators" SMID Recommended List	773	-1.47	-0.95	-0.05	-7.06	5.30	-3.33
	Citi "Thematic 30" Recommended List	157	-2.61	1.47	1.80	10.96	7.38	7.07
Key Macros	10-Year Treasury (%, end of period)	5.19	5.28	4.98	4.58	4.25	4.02	4.17
	10-Year TIPS Breakeven (% end of period)	2.36	2.36	2.37	2.26	2.39	2.31	2.27
	Crude Oil WTI (NYM $/bbl, end of period)	95.09	88.28	101.39	79.34	91.28	58.70	57.42
	Gold (NYM $/ozt, end of period)	4,108	4,141	4,352	4,070	4,850	4,163	4341.10
	US Dollar Index (end of period)	102.55	102.24	99.39	100.92	98.12	99.05	98.32

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Source: Bloomberg, FactSet, Citi Research.

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Appendix A-1

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